Thea (Cheng) Wu

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EDUCATION

Columbia University, Engineering | GPA: 3.8/4.0 *New York, NY*
Master of Science in Data Science **Expected Dec 2026**

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign | GPA: 3.9/4.0, Highest Honors *Champaign, IL*
Bachelor of Science in Econometrics & Quantitative Economics, Minor in Statistics **May 2025**

WORK EXPERIENCE

Intrinio, Financial Data Infrastructure Platform for Fintechs & Institutions **Sep 2026 - Present**
Data Analytics Consultant, Columbia *New York, NY*

- Modeled customer renewal propensity and price response in **Python/SQL** using logistic regression and **XGBoost**, achieving **0.81 out-of-sample ROC-AUC** across alternative pricing scenarios
- Structured a multi-tier risk-scoring workflow, routing accounts into automated pricing paths versus human review based on churn risk and contract complexity
- Designed a **value-versus-risk customer segmentation framework** and Streamlit/Power BI dashboards combining usage, renewal risk, and account value for revenue scenario analysis

Tarte Cosmetics, Leading U.S. Prestige Makeup Brand **Oct 2025 - May 2026**
Compliance Intern, Risk Analytics *New York, NY*

- Built a **Python/SQL co**mpliance risk-scoring model across 7 legacy systems and calibrated **escalation thresholds** using historical reviewer overrides and Precision@K, Recall, and Lift; reduced low-yield alerts by **25%** while preserving all material exceptions in the highest-priority review tier
- Identified 12 recurring workflow and control breakdowns responsible for 40% of audit delays through Pareto root-cause analysis and built Power BI risk-monitoring dashboards, contributing to a **22% reduction** in repeat compliance issues

Donglai Natural BioTech **Jun 2024 - Sep 2024**
Data Scientist Intern *Champaign, IL*

- Integrated customer, transaction, and digital-channel data across **10K+ customers** and developed RFM segmentation and repeat-purchase **propensity models**, achieving **0.78 ROC-AUC**
- Constructed a weekly **Marketing Mix Model** across 5+ channels using adstock, saturation, and regularized regression; translated model output into MROI and budget-allocation scenarios with **~10% higher** modeled incremental **contribution** under fixed-budget constraints
- Estimated price and promotion elasticities across **50+ SKUs** and designed **3+ A/B tests** using power/MDE and guardrail metrics, supporting customer-facing changes that delivered a **mid-single-digit relative conversion lift**

Research Assistant to Professor Elizabeth T. Powers, UIUC **Jan 2024 - Jul 2024**

- Applied **Difference-in-Differences, Instrumental Variables, and Propensity Score Matching** across two policy research projects on childcare-grant programs and education-access/economic-mobility disparities, assessing effects on employment, household income, and child-welfare outcomes

Zheshang Securities, Major Publicly Listed Chinese Securities Firm **May 2023 - Sep 2023**
Data Analyst Intern *Hangzhou, China*

- Developed **alpha-signal models** (Random Forest, regression, multivariate analytics) across 20+ private equity deals and multi-factor risk models with performance attribution supporting systematic portfolio construction; backtested the resulting alpha strategies
- Standardized SQL risk-reporting and reconciliation logic across 15+ valuation, exposure, and risk fields for 50K+ financial records, using historical baselines and z-score anomaly detection to reduce manual reconciliation effort by **70%**
- Performed scenario and sensitivity analysis for 10+ quarterly investment reviews, translating changes in portfolio assumptions into impact estimates and stakeholder recommendations

SELECTED PROJECTS

AI Document Intelligence | RAG System **Aug 2025 - Jan 2026**

- Engineered and evaluated a multi-document **RAG** system using Sentence-Transformers, FAISS, and LangChain; improved grounded-answer accuracy from **62% to 87%** across a structured 27-case evaluation benchmark

SKILLS

Python, SQL, R, STATA, scikit-learn, PySpark, dbt, MongoDB, Git, Excel/VBA, Tableau